6.13. NETWORKS

A network is set of interconnected devices (sometime referred as nodes) which are used to transmit data between them with agreed protocols. The networks are used to connect the people, machines, devices to share the data anywhere in the world. The devices can be computers, printers, mobile phones, servers which are capable of sending and receiving data.

The data can be generated by a device. There is considerable confusion in the literature between a computer network and a distributed system. The key distinction is that in a distributed system, a collection of independent computers appears to its users as a single coherent system (Figure 6.4).

Usually, it has a single model or paradigm that it presents to the users. Often a layer of software on top of the operating system, called middleware, is responsible for implementing this model. A well-known example of a distributed system is the World Wide Web, in which everything looks like a document (Web page).

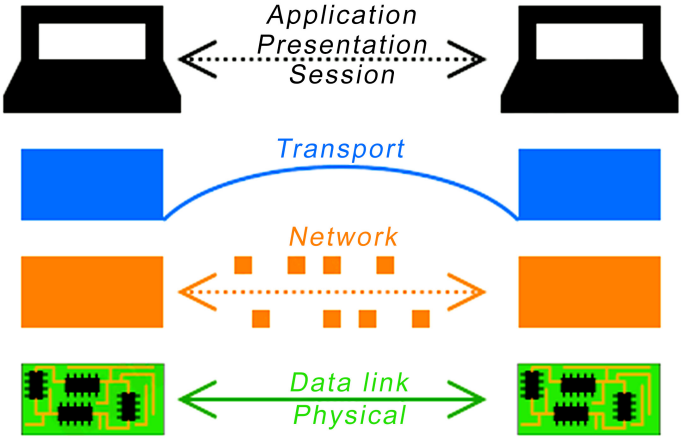

Figure 6.4. How do network work?

Source: Image by Explain that stuff.

6.14. HISTORY OF NETWORK

A computer network is a digital telecommunications network which allows nodes to share resources. In computer networks, computing devices exchange data with each other using connections (data links) between nodes. These data links are established over cable media such as wires or optic cables, or wireless media such as Wi-Fi.

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